telling what role Khyam would have played with Lashkar had he completed the course. His family in Britain was anxious to secure his safe return and, through contacts in Pakistan's Military Intelligence, located him at a Lashkar camp in the mountains. Messages were relayed to commanders at the camp and Khyam agreed to meet his grandfather, who was waiting in the valley below to take him home.[172] His jihadi dreams were deferred, but not for long. Four years later Khyam was arrested for leading a group of homegrown British jihadis known as the 'Crevice Network,' who planned to explode a fertilizer bomb in the UK.[173] By that time he had graduated to working with al-Qaeda and was coordinating his attack plans with one of its high-level operatives in Pakistan.[174]

Lashkar's transnational networks spanned several continents by 9/11, but unlike al-Qaeda it was not using these overseas operatives to launch attacks against the US or its allies. The two outfits shared numerous connections and both embraced a pan-Islamist ideology, but had taken different paths. While al-Qaeda agitated for war against America, Lashkar embraced a jihad that prioritized war against Pakistan's rival, India. Although the reasons for Lashkar's focus on the Kashmir jihad and Pakistan's support for it were not the same, the group and the state found common cause in the fight against India. Lashkar benefited greatly from this arrangement as state assistance allowed it to construct a potent military apparatus and a powerful support infrastructure in Pakistan, including a vast social welfare infrastructure. Yet despite its robust operations in Pakistan and international reach, Lashkar had no significant interests in neighboring Afghanistan. Pakistan's Deobandi groups, on the other hand, had become more enmeshed in the Taliban-al-Qaeda nexus that developed during the 1990s. Al-Qaeda's attacks against America on September 11 irrevocably altered the future of the jihadi movement. The ensuing US counter-attack in Afghanistan also forced the Pakistani government, and hence its militant proxies, to navigate a much more complicated environment.